Mills of the Gods

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General Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Characters:
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Angel/Demon AU, semi modern au, semi Office AU, whoops would you look at that I made a new series, focus on executive leadership this time, World building mostly, mostly internal monolgue with minimal dialog, Angella Needs a Hug (She-Ra), why is there no tag for Angella needs a hug y'all I'm crying!, Yeet Horde Prime Into the Sun 2kXX, rampant abuse of aether, Cycles of Eternity

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Part 2 of As Above, So Below

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by Nny11

Summary

The mills of the gods grinds slowly, but the grind exceedingly fine.

So what are Angella and Horde Prime up to anyways?

Notes

Part of the series As Above, So Below. You can probably read on it's own, but it will make much more sense if you read On Her Shoulders first.

At the Top

Let them.

Angella could feel the anger warring inside her with guilt, with hurt, with a bone deep sadness. She watched the small bit of aether swirl around again, a gently pulsing purple that no one else would see. Was she truly so horrible that any would go behind her back? Did they loathe her so? Had she not given them everything she could? An eternity of servitude, cast aside for reasons she could not fathom. In these moments when her emotions became too large and too loud, when she feared the consequences of them, she would picture him.

And her dear, sweet Micah would speak to her in her mind's eye. And for this, he whispered once more.

Let them, let them see there is nothing to fear, to hate, to rage against.

"But what if there is?" She whispered back, eyes tracking the infiltrator with an icy numbness.

Angella herself could not fathom what that might be, but she was no fool. Time always marched forwards and the system which had run for the whole of this cycle was finally being questioned. Perhaps she was in the wrong (Angella smiled wanly at that she could think of one specific person who would jump and screech that particular opinion) for perpetuation. Creation was not often about innovation, Creation alone was mindless, thoughtless, and careless. That was the realm and the purpose of angels, after all. To guide it, to give shape to it, to responsibly shepherd it. They were the custodians of Creation and ensured as much peace on Earth as possible.

It isn't as if you haven't changed too.

No, no she supposed it wasn't. The human industrial revolution had gone off with a bang down in the Fright Zone and with so many demons rising and angels falling, the transference of some of those ideas had been bound to happen. Commpads, terminals, electricity, all could be replicated to work in Bright Moon by the grace of Creation and all had with Angella's blessing. Of course she still struggled with it herself, poor Glimmer was bound to consign herself to the void if Angella needed assistance one more time accessing calls on her personal CP.

Good thing Bow wouldn't.

She couldn't muster a smile for the thought as the aether stretched and thinned and wove itself into a new section becoming nearly invisible again. Had Bow had a hand in this? He was one of their best engineers, coming up with fascinating new forms and ideas to send to the humans. Pushing the idea of innovation and creativity forward where they could. Not the most practical ideas, many of them were silly, but the vast bulk made human lives easier, simpler. Not revolutionary but kind. His allegiance to her daughter could not be fully overlooked, but she had a sinking feeling she knew the true culprit.

She may be curious.

Perhaps. Entrapta was not known for her consideration of consequences. But she was also not known for discretion despite the many secrets she kept, probably far more than any of them knew. Technically, she was a fallen angel, but many things did not apply to her and if not for her rapid transference of being, Angella would have long ago made her the lead engineer in Bright Moon. Brilliant, absolutely brilliant! Her inventions ranged from modest to profound and often improved many lives, but they were also very likely to cause unintended harm as well. Entrapta was most interested in the act of discovery and invention itself, much like Creation, but was often hampered to the point of descending once more to see them to fruition among the demons who craved stimulation and change. It was terribly ironic that the one most

similar to Creation was made the least suited to guide it by the same token.

Yes, this was most likely Entrapta, and yes it was most likely curiosity.

And yet she could not ignore the broader picture.

Mermista's rise had not seemed odd at the time, even if her friendship with Perfuma was. Entrapta's almost forceful entry into that friendship barely brought her attention either. Frosta, one of her youngest angels, becoming invested had sparked interest and concern until she realized Bow was also part of whatever strange troop this was.

Which is when she became concerned to realize her daughter was not.

She could be learning boundaries? The Micah inside of her smiled hopefully before drooping. *Fine, yes, she's conspiring. Can you blame her?*

No that wasn't quite right, it wasn't that Angella blamed Glimmer for feeling bored or isolated, it had not been her intention even if it ultimately was part of the design. But Angella couldn't give her up, was too scared to loose her, not after-

My choice. Our decision, but my choice.

Creation could not make from nothing. Entropy took and took and took for the void, and Creation used and used and used. To create a newer, stronger She-Ra, Light Hope had called her lover home to be reclaimed in the void together. To create a newer, stronger principality required sacrifice too, but Bright Moon could not go without a so called princess. Micah had been a strong archangel, powerful and charming and kind. He was not the only angel to return to the void that day, but he was the one she loved the most.

Glimmer would understand. One day she would understand the beauty and tragedy and love of her creation. A fraction of Angella's own powers and a great sacrifice of love from many. Glimmer was strong and brave. Compassionate, when she let herself move past her obstinance- first to throw a punch and first to forgive. Micah would have been so damned proud.

And Angella was scared.

How very typical of her.

Peace, love, peace.

"There is no peace when my own daughter conspires against me. When the future of our kind, our duty, our blessings flock to her. She could ask me." Angella winced even as she spoke the words, they were false from love but weak therefore. She began to pace allowing the bit of aether freedom to move fully once more. Now that she had the taste of its magic there was nowhere it could hide from her, it was too bright for that now.

Perhaps she should accelerate the timeline? Oh dear, that rarely went well for her. Humans had not forgotten the floods that came from Angella's heated holy war, and she would never forgive herself the harm she had done. So many lost, the void never grew or shrank, but it certainly had eaten well and Prime had been more than pleased to kill as many demons and angels alike as possible. His concern was strictly in the order of unity, the fewer beings to exist, the less angels could help to guide Creation, the less able it became to produce. Once all was gone, this cycle would end, and it would take new eternities to begin again.

Angella knew this cold war had waged before, even if the shape was unknown. So above, the same below, and the bitter truth was this:

Angels win every battle, but Demons win every war.

And Angella did not need any combination of them to speed the process up. Not when Prime was so prepared. No. No, she needed

to stick to the schedule, and when Glimmer grew fully into her powers then Angella could gift her the rest. Join Micah and rest at last.

Hearsay, perhaps, for the princess of Bright Moon to abdicate the position freely. But this was not the era of quiet in between when princesses came and went frequently to guide without draining Creation further, nor was it the era of interstellar nurseries that she had been born during where mistakes could be made and were expected. Prime had always been there, he was always the first to be made anew, for nothing more could be made until it too could return to the void. Back then he'd been weak, hamstrung between giving the void that which it demanded of him and keeping just enough power to create his demon hordes. No, now he was powerful, set and settled, just as Angella was.

And there was only one way to become more than Prime was.

No. She could not budge on something so important. A failure on her part could mean the end of Glimmer, and if Glimmer was returned… Angella would not survive that. Her heart would not survive that. Her love, old, brittle, and tattered as it was from the eons she had watched all else come (as proud as any mother holding her newborn in wonder) and go (as bereft as any mother forced to bury them in a too small coffin) would not survive that. And Angella would return, and there would be no princess to oppose Prime, and it would all end and it would all be her fault! It would all be her fault for being so selfish and so foolish!

Peace. She could almost feel the warmth of Micah's hands, one on her waist the other her chest over her heart, soothing the ache in her soul. She could smell that bitter edge of magic and the floral sting of incense. She closed her eyes to force the tears back and let her imagination bring something forth that could never truly be created again. *Peace.*

She could speak with Glimmer about this intrusion, but she may deny all and perhaps, even worse, she may truly know nothing.

She could speak with her little rebels directly, but that could spook them into something unwise considering her firm belief that there were more like them in the Fright Zone.

She could speak with Prime but that was nothing but a disaster waiting to happen which would give him far too much power.

Or she could take the same path she always took, the cautious path, the coward's path. It was safest for all involved. It would be different if She-Ra had been created again, her archangel of protection, but Creation stalled. It hemmed and hawed in place of speaking, and She-Ra was gone. With She-Ra at her side, Angella could take more bold action. Without her, without Micah, without true hope in anything beyond her ability to keep some semblance of the status quo… it was forgone.

Angella watched helplessly as the altered bit of aether wormed its way deeper. She could only pray they would find what they needed from this deception. She could only pray it was not the beginning of the end.

At The Bottom

Chapter Summary

> As above, so below, Prime thinks on his own plans and rebels.

Chapter Notes

> Y'all why did no one yell at me when I forgot to update this? I have a brain like swiss cheese, please!

Lord Prime, the first of Creation’s children, the survivor of the void, he who sees all, knows all, smiled faintly to himself. Demons were little more than a facsimile of his kind, and despite what the Princess of Bright Moon may have one think, he was a powerful angel. More powerful than she was, more powerful than her successors. The first to be born, the last to die, Prime retained many of his memories from the past cycles, as all was created from that which had been returned, the memories were out there and with time and patience he learned how to find those holding shards of his light in them.

The Children, his Brothers and Sisters, they were just about found out now. He could feel it.

The eyes of the court turned, even if the demons could not see it, and when she spoke he smiled. His next Little Sister was found and she was strong. The more powerful she became before returning to his fold, the more powerful he in turn would be, the more powerful the void could become. The anticipation was euphoric.

“My Lord?”

His physical eyes snapped back to focus, his Little Brother, the last of his shards, stood before him in terror and rapture as all demons should. This one held the essence of his physical form, it made locating him so much simpler. But that had been centuries ago

and Prime's hunger had grown. Hordak was a small sliver of his light, granted rank and status almost by accident and giving little back except his loyalty. And even that was fracturing.

"I heard you Brother. You know my answer, so why ask again?"

Hordak's face twitched, a sign he had been feeling without permission, thinking without guidance, perhaps making facial expressions which were strictly forbidden. All possible and as much as it disgusted and disheartened Prime, it was best to let Hordak hang himself with his own rope. The longer drops were far more entertaining and often caught more that Prime could take or return. He would not be the first Child to conspire against Prime, nor would he be the last. Cycles did not repeat for nothing, after all, and if he could end this one-

Oh the peace. The quiet. The calm. No chaos, no fear, no pain. Lord Prime knew many believed that the devil loved the suffering of others, but it simply wasn't true. His heart bled for them, truly it did. But human suffering brought more power to their demise, and the more that Entropy could take, the closer Prime could get to ending that suffering forever.

A new kindness would rise that way. Angels were a sad and sadistic lot that way, but he always won in the end. And someday Creation would grow too tired, too weak, too old to continue. It too would collapse into the void and then there would be true peace.

He could not fathom what might happen without Creation, and the mere prospect brought a warmth to his very soul.

And so he let his Brothers and his Sisters make mistakes and missteps. Hordak would be no more than a blip, the same as Skeletor. Forgotten by the demons too enraptured by Prime's generosity. He gave them a pittance of power to create their own ghastly self-destructing means and it brought him great joy to see Angella copy even a fraction of the Fright Zone's creations.

“My Lord-”

Oh yes, he’d already forgotten the little lad himself! He smiled as he watched through other’s eyes, allowing the words to connect to his memory directly from Hordak’s mind and throat. He craved her. Her wanted her. Lust, greed, even envy mixed inside of him as he watched her leave a building on the other side of the city alongside her bumbling compatriot. She was in direct negotiations now with Angella’s own daughter, the powers she would gain through the skills she had honed!

And none of them thanks to his Brother, who once more stood arguing for her removal.

“It was not legal, My Lord, it was not proper, you must see that!”

Prime frowned and Hordak straightened in fear. “What a dire accusation, dear Brother. Do you truly believe I would allow such a thing without express permission?” Hordak’s rage was delightful and quaint! But they both knew if he pressed the matter all hell would break loose. Literally.

Prime knew all, saw all. He’d known of Catra’s little live watch. He’d been furious at first but considering Glimmer’s attendance he could only be proud. It was one thing to corrupt a human, especially one as upstanding as that one, but it was another entirely to corrupt an angel. Few fell unwillingly these days, Prime and Angella had long come to an unhappy but adequate arrangement to handle the flow of demons upwards and angels downwards, so when they did truly fall against their will it made them that much more powerful. Shadow Weaver had twice the power she’d had as an archangel, which she’d doubled again with her double cross. Her first falling came strictly from her own greed, and the difference it had made had been immense. Entire human countries had fallen under her will or her direction to the demons underneath her. The sway palpable enough to make Angella desperate.

And the creation of a new princess on purpose was nothing short of desperate.

If Prime could not have Angella through her fear and sloth, he could still, perhaps, get her daughter instead.

To have a shard of himself already working towards such a lofty goal… well, it made him proud.

And this worm, this pathetic misshapen little monster dared to question his will?

Hordak bowed deeply. “I understand now, My Lord. Thank you for your wisdom and clarity, I won’t bother you again.”

No. He’d thought not.

“We all make mistakes, Brother. See that you learn from them, hmm?”

The choir sang around him, a deafening screech of fervor and joy so bright and beautiful it became painful. “Hail Lord Prime, glory be onto him! Cast off your shadows, and be saved in his eternal light!” Hordak limped away, well dismissed and ashamed and angry. Lord Prime smiled benevolently all the same.

All creatures, no matter how small, had a place at his side.

Hordak returned part of Prime to him, and now he would unwittingly return his little rebels as well. Prime knew who they were, they believed themselves far more subtle than they were, and once they truly stepped past the line, Prime would strike. Make an example of each of them, drag them back to the Fright Zone from Brightmoon by force, force each of them to skuttle like bugs before him. To scrape their bellies and beg his forgiveness.

And he would give it to them.

He would allow them to join the Children, to join their power to his, to be one with the light. They would agree, for all beings fear

death and believed his light to be a continuation instead of a death. It wasn't completely true, their souls would be woven into his over time, their power would become his, their bodies would become withered husks in a few eons. And when his work was finished they would all step with him into the light of Entropy, into the void to be made anew.

And if they did not beg for his forgiveness… well, he had yet to meet an angel or a demon that lasted long under the full might of his wrath. They would break. They all eventually did. And they would find peace the likes of which they could never conceive of. He would take the pains from their hearts. They would be happy until the end, pleased to aid him however he needed.

Perhaps he would let Hordak retain himself. His power was weak, his uses limited, but his suffering would bring him strength and clarity in time. Lording his Little Sister over him would hurt, showing that his efforts had been wasted would hurt, showing him how small and stupid he was would hurt. Ripping that damnable angel he was so taken by apart would destroy him. Prime could guide Creation as well as any princess, after all, he could make Hordak into something worthwhile.

Lord Prime smiled as the choir sang. "All beings must suffer to become pure!"

And was Hordak not once the purest of them all? He could be again. After Prime had his fill of her, he would reclaim that which belonged to him already.

Soon enough he could then defile the daughter of the princess, and with Angella's fall from her broken heart Prime would do as he always had. Complete his mission, wipe the slate clean, bring peace to everything in existence.

Yes.

Soon. Very soon.

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